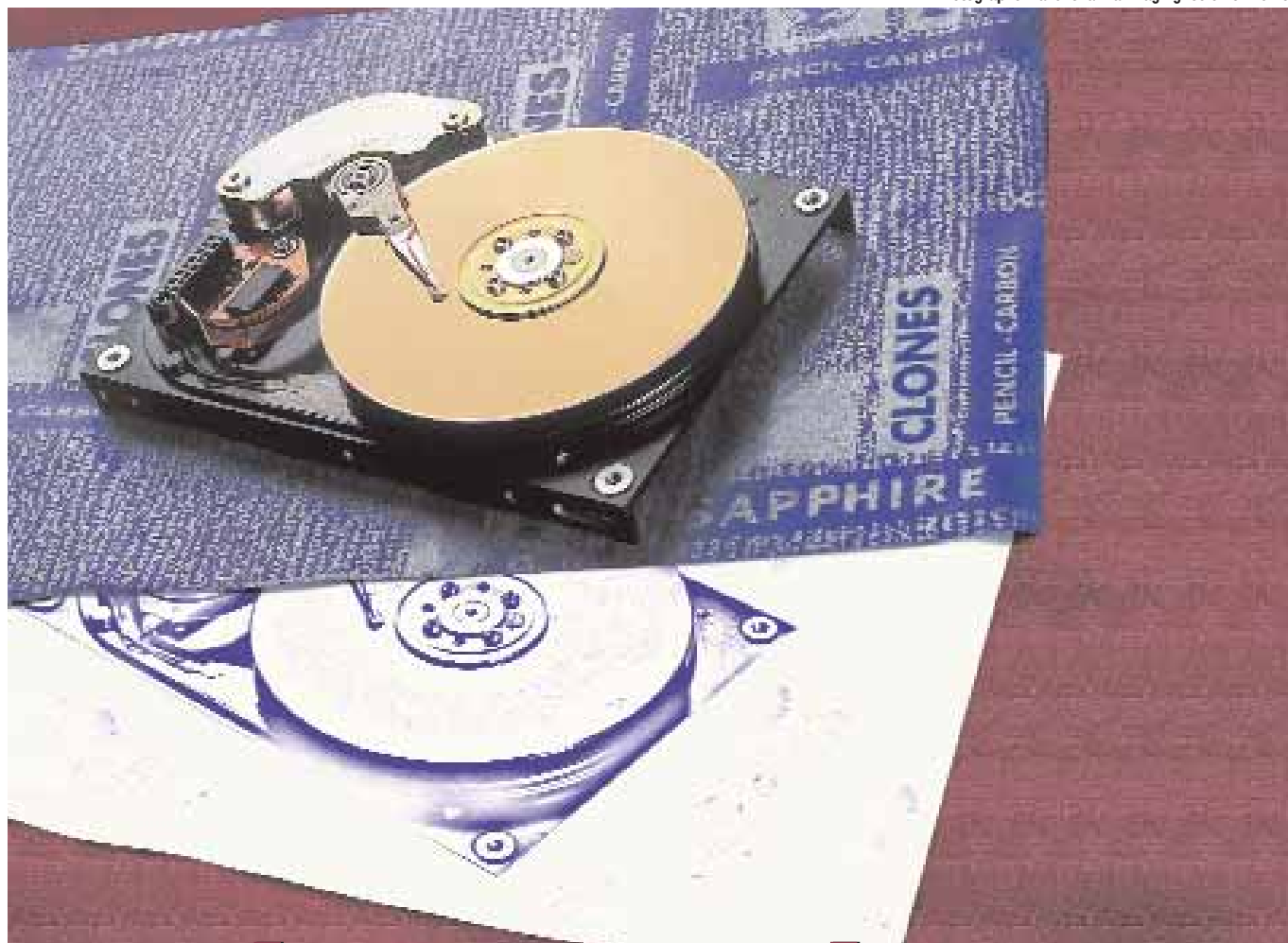




In its own image

Is the fear of system crashes getting to you? Well don't give it a second thought... just clone your system settings

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Image is everything. What would the British be without the stiff upper lip, the Japanese without the perfectionist attitude and the Americans without Marilyn Monroe? But hey, nobody is perfect. We all have experienced the occasional flaw in our defences. What follows thereafter is the long process of rebuilding from scratch. But if you have the right image, then this process of rebuilding is not too difficult.

Now hold on a minute—we still are your favourite technology magazine and we are not about to take you through a psychology test for your self-esteem. What we are talking about is an image of your hard disk, and not your own! It's the one thing that will come to your rescue if you face a system crash.

What causes this?

Over time, all the shareware, demos, trial versions and other goodies that you may have

installed courtesy the Internet, results in a clutter building up on your hard drive in the form of .dll, .txt and other assorted files. To add to the mess, even programs that you may have removed using the uninstall feature, leave behind files that are of no use to you. All versions of Windows, right from 3.1 to Windows 2000 have been without a good enough uninstall program. Eventually 'the blue screen of death' starts popping up on your monitor like a screensaver, indicating that Windows is misbehaving and needs to be disciplined.

Having to go through the rigorous procedure of formatting your hard drive, reinstalling all the software you've lost and reconfiguring your PC settings as per your preferences can be a tiresome process. But hey, this doesn't mean that you give up all those shareware and freeware to combat frequent system crashes or slowdowns. It's always a good idea to clone your system settings, your operating system, frequently used

